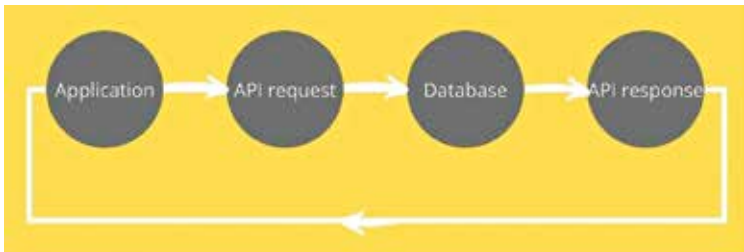


This chapter will help such individuals by explaining the API testing process with SoapUI in the simplest way possible. But, before deep-diving into API testing using SoapUI, here are some of the basic concepts revolving around API, API testing, and SoapUI.

## What is an API?

An API or an Application Programming Interface is a software that acts as an intermediary for communication between different applications. API consists of clearly defined rules regarding how various applications will talk (exchange data).

The working of an API can be represented diagrammatically as follows;



To give you a real-world analogy related to an API, imagine you are at a restaurant. You communicate your order to the waiter. They then take the information from you (food order) to the chef. After the chef has prepared the dish, the waiter takes the dish from the chef and serves you. In this case, the waiter is the API who acts as a communicating link between you and the chef, passing only the required information (dish request) between you.

## What is API testing?

API testing is testing the designed API software to verify that it functions as intended. It helps the testers determine whether the API meets the required functionality, security, reliability, and performance levels. If there are any shortcomings, the tester/developer can make the necessary changes to the API before making the API available to the general user.

## What are the benefits of API testing?

API testing offers a plethora of benefits. Here is a list of the four major benefits of API testing that can help boost confidence and increase exposure to API testing for beginners: